

High-chance portions — env-biodiversity

Combined original study articles for this topic's highest-probability PYQ themes.

Protected Areas, WPA & Species

~50% · Protected area categories · WPA schedules · Species habitats

National Parks, Wildlife Sanctuaries, Biosphere Reserves and Wildlife Protection Act.

Why UPSC asks this

Among highest Prelims environment weightage — map + law + species.

Category differences

Know legal/management differences among NP, WLS, Conservation Reserves, Community Reserves, Biosphere Reserves, Tiger Reserves overlays. Ramsar wetlands often co-asked.

Species & habitats

Match critically endangered/flagship species to landscapes (tiger landscapes, Gangetic dolphin, Great Indian Bustard, etc.). Invasive species and corridor ecology appear.

Law

WPA schedules; CITES awareness; Biodiversity Act institutions (NBA) at outline level.

Must remember

- NP > WLS in restriction intensity (textbook contrast)
- Biosphere Reserve — core/buffer/transition
- WPA 1972 schedules protect species at graded levels

Biodiversity Hotspots & Global Conventions

~42% · Hotspots · CBD · Species conventions

Indian hotspot logic plus CBD/CITES/CMS-type treaty hooks.

Why UPSC asks this

International environmental architecture pairs with domestic biodiversity facts.

Hotspots

Definition criteria; Indian-related hotspots list; Western Ghats endemism examples.

Conventions

CBD, Nagoya Protocol idea, CITES permit logic, migratory species CMS — know purpose one-liners.

Must remember

- Hotspot criteria: richness + endemism + threat
- CBD objectives: conservation, sustainable use, benefit sharing